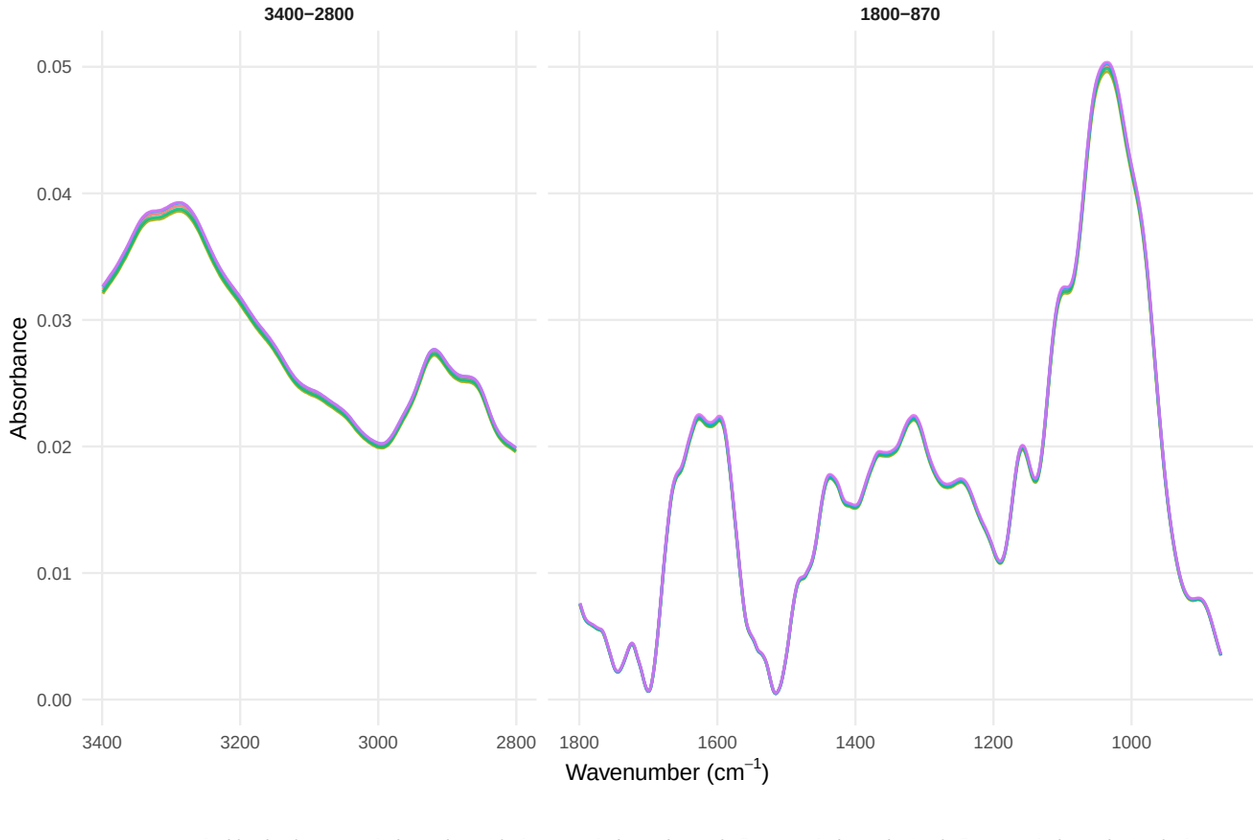
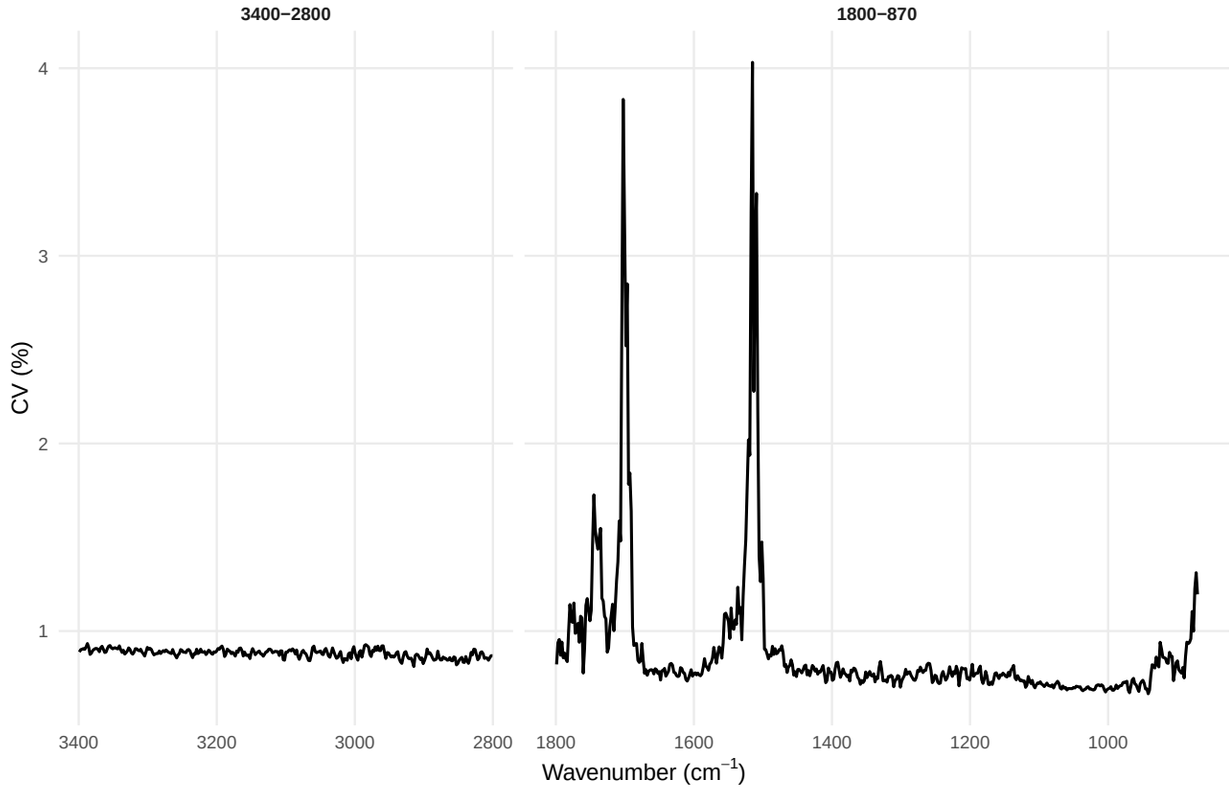
A

## Archived and independently measured unused strips




B

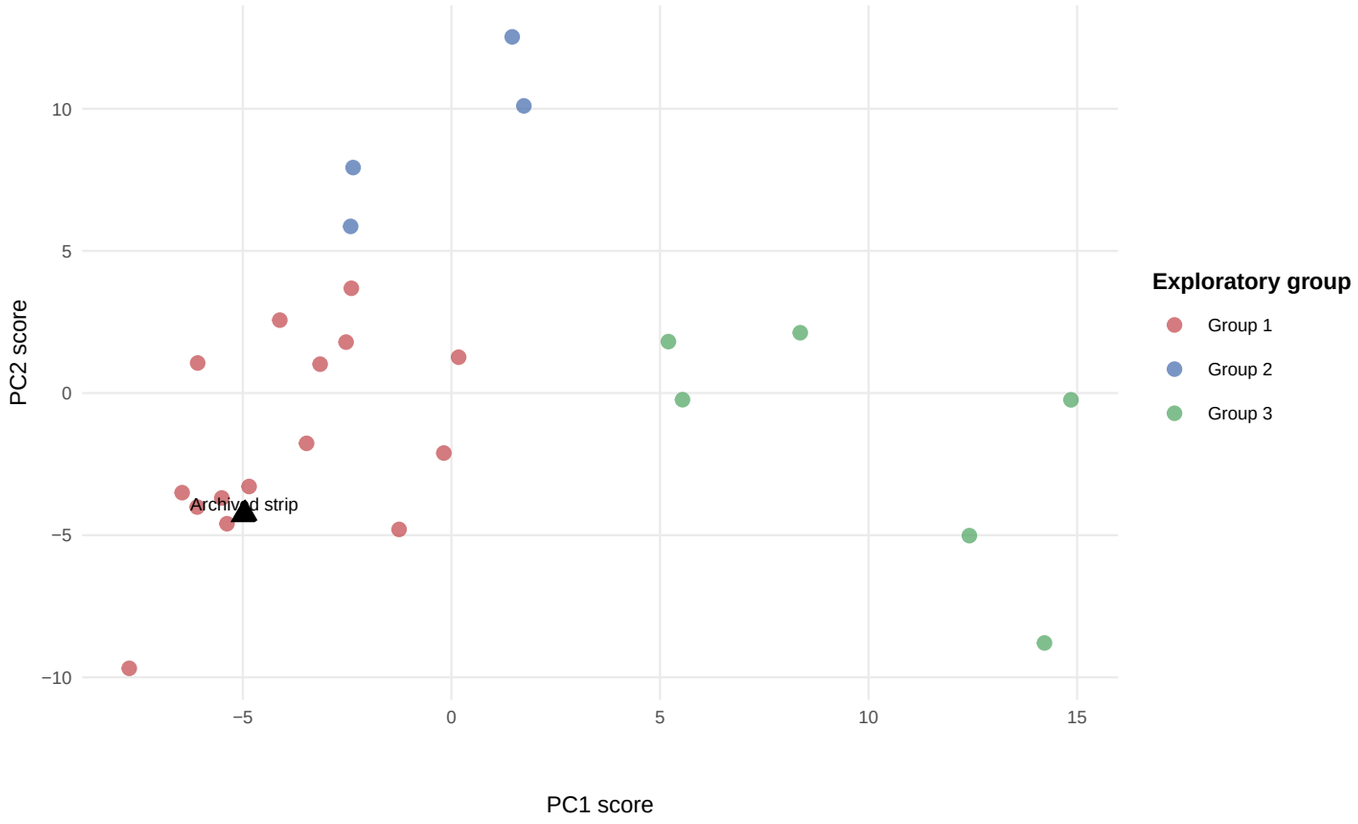
## Pointwise variability across four independent strips



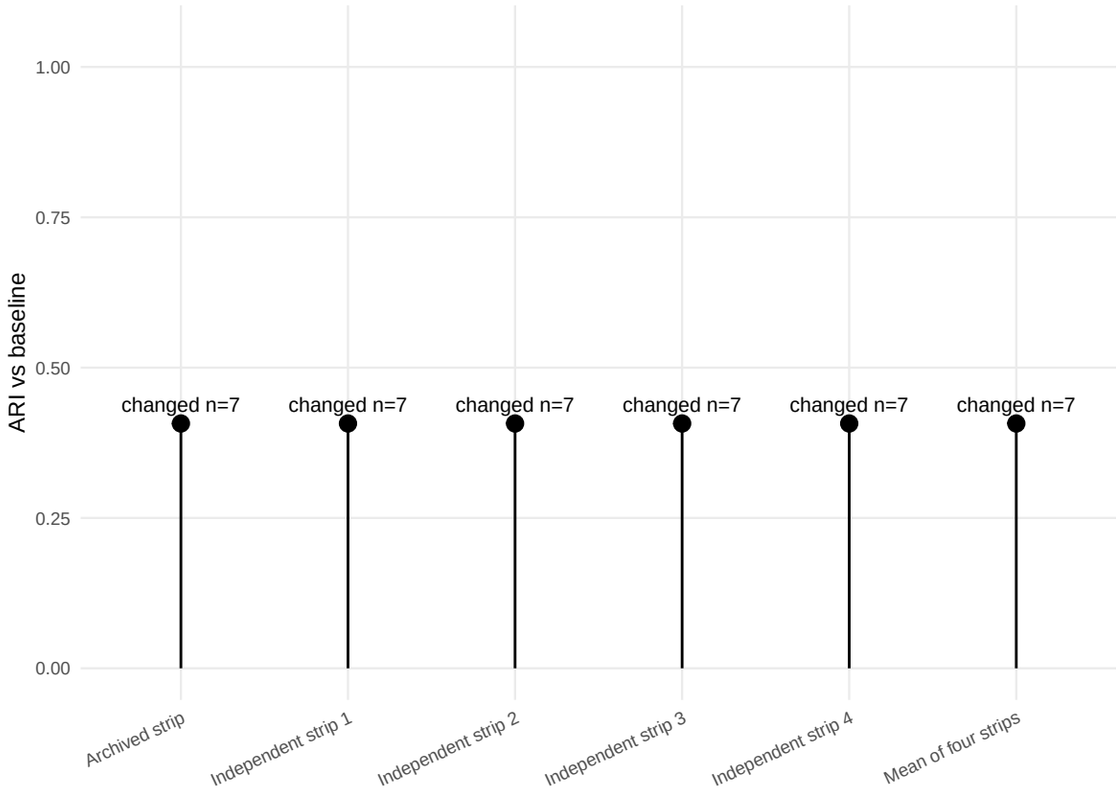

C

## Clean−strip references projected into the fixed pediatric PCA space

Reference spectra do not contribute to the PCA axes




D

## Sensitivity to the selected clean−strip direction

The same fixed 3−PC / Ward.D2 / k=3 procedure is repeated